

Irish Gaelic Self-Study Progress Tracker

— User Guide

What This Tracker Is For

Learning Irish Gaelic is a personal journey. Whether you're reconnecting with your heritage, preparing for the Teastas Eorpach na Gaeilge (TEG) certification exam, or simply passionate about the language, this tracker helps you stay organized, notice patterns in your learning, and build sustainable study habits.

This simple CSV spreadsheet is designed for self-study learners at all levels—from casual heritage learners to formal exam candidates. Track your daily progress across the four key language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Monitor vocabulary acquisition, grammar pattern coverage, and study consistency. If you're preparing for TEG certification, optional exam-tracking columns help you log mock scores and countdown to test day.

Column Guide

Core Columns (All Learners)

Date: The date of your study session. Format: YYYY-MM-DD (e.g., 2026-08-21).

Study Hours: Total hours spent studying Irish on that day (e.g., 1.5 for 90 minutes). Be realistic—include only focused study, not passive listening during your commute unless you're actively engaging with comprehension.

Vocabulary Words Learned: New Irish words or phrases you actively learned or reviewed. Example: "12" means you learned 12 new words. This helps you track vocabulary growth over weeks and months.

Grammar Patterns Covered: The number of distinct grammar structures you studied (e.g., lenition rules, conditional mood, past tense formations). Irish grammar has unique patterns—mutations, VSO word order, prepositional conjugation—tracking these patterns helps you notice what you're covering versus what gaps remain.

Listening Practice Minutes: Minutes spent actively listening to Irish content (podcasts, videos, tutor sessions). Passive background listening counts only if you're comprehending with focus.

Speaking Practice Minutes: Time spent speaking Irish—conversation with native speakers, tutors, language exchange partners, or even self-recorded practice. This is the hardest skill to track but essential for fluency.

Writing Practice Minutes: Time spent writing in Irish—journal entries, forum posts, homework, or creative writing exercises.

Reading Practice Minutes: Time reading Irish books, news, blog posts, or study materials. Track the time you're engaged, not skimmed.

Study Streak: Consecutive days of study. Reset to 1 if you miss a day. Streaks are motivational; they show momentum and discipline.

Notes: Any observations worth recording. What grammar structures confuse you? Did you have a breakthrough moment? Are you preparing for an exam? Write context here—it's your personal learning journal embedded in your tracker.

Optional Columns (TEG Exam Candidates)

Mock Exam Score: If you're taking practice exams before sitting TEG, log your mock scores. This column is optional—leave it blank if you're not doing exam prep. Example: "68" represents 68% on a practice test.

Days to TEG Exam: If you've registered for the Teastas Eorpach na Gaeilge certification, enter the number of days remaining until your exam date. This creates a countdown that keeps exam-focused learning urgent and organized. Leave blank if you're not exam-focused.

Why Consistent Tracking Matters

For Heritage Learners and Casual Learners

Reconnecting with Irish—your heritage language—is deeply personal. Tracking lets you see real progress: vocabulary growth, consistency in daily practice, and skill development across listening, speaking, reading, and writing. After a month of logging, you'll recognize patterns: maybe you excel at reading but avoid speaking, or you're stronger in listening than writing. These insights let you adjust. Tracking also builds accountability and motivation—seeing a 15-day study streak feels real and earned.

For TEG Exam Candidates

The TEG exam tests reading, listening, writing, and speaking across levels A1 (absolute beginner) through C1 (advanced). Tracking mock exam scores over weeks shows whether your study strategy is working. If mock scores stall, you can adjust focus. Countdown columns keep exam preparation urgent without

panic. Many exam-takers discover that consistent daily study (1–2 hours) over 8–12 weeks is far more effective than cramming.

Universal Insight

Language learning is not linear. Some days you'll study for 3 hours; others for 30 minutes. Some topics click instantly; others take weeks. This tracker doesn't judge. It records. Over months, patterns emerge: your true study capacity, the grammar structures you master quickly, your natural learning rhythm. Use these patterns to build a sustainable practice, not a frustrating one.

How to Use This Tracker

1. Download the tracker and open it in Excel, Google Sheets, Numbers, or any spreadsheet app.
2. Enter today's date in the first column.
3. Log your study time and activities in the relevant columns. Don't overthink precision—rough estimates are fine.
4. Add a note explaining your session or any reflection.
5. If preparing for TEG, fill in mock exam scores and days remaining.
6. Review your tracker weekly: Are you hitting your target study hours? Which skill needs more attention? Are streaks motivating you?
7. Use the data. After a month, you'll have real insights into your Irish learning journey.

Tips for Success

Be consistent but realistic about study time. A daily 30-minute habit beats sporadic 5-hour cram sessions. Log immediately after studying while details are fresh. Use notes to track breakthroughs, frustrations, and patterns—your future self will thank you. For exam candidates, balance all four skills; don't neglect speaking or writing even when reading feels easier. For heritage learners, celebrate small wins: conversations with family, understanding a song, reading a story—your tracker is your proof of progress.

This tracker is a tool to organize your Irish learning, notice patterns, and celebrate consistency. Your Irish journey is uniquely yours—let this tracker reflect that.